**Ans. (c)**

"Jana Gana Mana" is the national anthem of India. Originally written in Bengali, it is the first of five stanzas of a Brahmo hymn composed and scored by Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore. It was first sung during Calcutta Session of the Indian National Congress on 27 December, 1911. "Jana Gana Mana" was officially adopted by the Constituent Assembly as the Indian National Anthem on 24 January, 1950.

**82. The last session of Indian National Congress attended by Bal Gangadhar Tilak was :**

(a) Calcutta Session, 1906 (b) Surat Session, 1907

(c) Calcutta Session, 1917 (d) Amritsar Session, 1919

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014**

**Ans. (d)**

The last session of Indian National Congress attended by Bal Gangadhar Tilak was Amritsar Session,1919. He had mellowed sufficiently to oppose Gandhi's policy of boycotting the elections to the legislative councils established as part of the reforms that followed from the Montagu-Chelmsford Report to Parliament in 1918. Instead, Tilak advised the delegates to follow his policy of 'responsive cooperation' in carrying out the reforms, which introduced a certain degree of Indian participation in regional Government. He died on 1st August, 1920.

# Moderates and Extremists in Congress

*The first two decades of INC is described in history as a moderate era. Some of the prominent moderate leaders were **Dadabhai Naoroji**, **Surendra Nath Banerjee**, **Mahadev Govind Ranade**, **Feroz Shah Mehta**, **Gopal Krishna Gokhale** and **Anand Mohan Bose**. They had a sense of confidence in British justice and their generosity. They never aimed at aggressive nationalism for attaining independence. Leaders like **Bal Gangadhar Tilak**, **Lala Lajpat Rai**, **Bipin Chandra Pal**, raised extremist ideology. *Dadabhai Naoroji, Pherozeshah Mehta, Dinsha Wacha, Womesh Chandra Banerjee and Surendra Nath Banerjee were leaders of Moderate group, they all belonged to urban areas, in fact most of the Moderate leaders who believed in moderate politics belonged to Urban areas. The Congress during moderate phase was dominated by people having professions like Advocates, Doctors, Engineers, Journalists and Person related to Literature works. The Connection to common masses was missing in Congress during Moderate domination. *Pherozeshah Mehta once said, "The voice of Congress is not of Masses, but it is the responsibility of citizens in contact with Congress to understand these emotions and propagate these to the Nation." *Gopal Krishna Gokhale was a moderate leader. He believed in the purity of Means and Ends. He was the political mentor (Guru) of Mahatma Gandhi. For the first time, he took part in politics in 1889. *In 1897 A.D., Gokhale and DinshawVacha were asked to present proofs of Indian expenditure in front of '**Welby Commission**'. In 1899 A.D., Gokhale was elected to Bombay legislative council and in 1901 A.D. was elected to Imperial council of the Governor general of India. *In 1906 A.D., Extremist leaders of Congress emerged in Indian Political Scenario. **Bal Gangadhar Tilak**, **Lala Lajpat Rai**, **Bipin Chandra Pal** and **Aurobindo Ghosh** were four important extremist leaders. Their main objective was **'Swaraj'**. They didn't believe in the agitation through constitutional means of the Moderates. They blamed the Congress for politics of Petition, Prayers and Protest. Under their leadership, the policy of petition and prayers ended. *Moderates believed in constitutional agitation, annual sessions, speeches, sending petitions to English Parliament, etc but extremists believed in self-sacrifice, mass movement, aggressive resistance and strong determination. *Extremists wanted 'Swaraj' as "complete Independence from English" on the other hand moderates believed in "Self rule under the colonial empire". ***Lala Lajpat Rai** also known as **Sher-e-Panjab,** was the representative from Punjab and an extremist leader. He is also known as **Punjab Kesari**. *Lala Lajpat Rai, Bipin Chandra Pal and Bal Gangadhar Tilak are together called **Lal-Bal-Pal**. During a protest against Simon Commission Lala Lajpat Rai was injured in lathi charge due to which he died on **17 November, 1928** A.D. After reading the Biography of **Mazzini** Lala Lajpat Rai accepted him as his political mentor. *He translated a work of Mazzini **'The Duty of Man'** in Urdu.

*During the Partition of Bengal, Aurobindo Ghosh was the main leader of the Swadeshi Movement. Other important leaders of this movement were Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal. Tilak believed in sacrifice and had courage to challenge British establishment. He was called the **"Father of Indian unrest"** by Sir Valentine Chirol. After the announcement of Tilak's sentence, Maxmuller wrote a letter to Privy Council asking mercy for Tilak describing him as a learned Individual of Sanskrit. *In 1908 A.D., Tilak was jailed for 6 Years in Mandalay (Myanmar) on the charges of treason initiated against him for printing an anti-British Article in his Newspaper 'Kesari'. *Tilak wrote **'Gita Rahasya'** from 'Mandale' prison. Starting **Shivaji Mahotsav** and **Ganpati festival,** he tried to grow the feeling of Nationalism amongst the masses. He died on 1st August, 1920 A.D., and his funeral bier was lifted by Mahatma Gandhi, Maulana Shauqat Ali and Saiffudin Kichlu. Maulana Hasrat Mohani read the eulogy after his death.

1. **Which of the following international events influenced the course of the national movement in India before the advent of Mahatma Gandhi?**
   **(1) Italian-Abyssinian War, 1898**
   **(2) Boxer Movement in China**
   **(3) Revolutionary Movement in Ireland**
   **(4) Victory of Japan in the Russo-Japanese War**
   (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
   (c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1994**

**Ans. (d)**

The Italian-Abyssinian War (in which the Italian colonial power was defeated), the Boxer movement against the imperialists in China during 1899-1901 A.D., and Japan's victory over Russia, influenced the direction of the national movement in India before the advent of Mahatma Gandhi, but among these, Japan's victory over Russia in the year 1905 A.D. had the most impact. Japan had proved itself militarily superior to a powerful European country by defeating Czarist Russia in the year 1905 A.D. This dispelled the false illusion that the people of the white race were invincible.

2. **Read the following statements regarding the liberal phase of the Indian National Movement (1885-1905 A.D.):**
   **1. Supported the rich democratic and scientific culture of modern Europe.**
   **2. Strongly criticized the economic aspects of British imperialism.**
   **Select the correct answer using the codes given below:**
   (a) Only 1 is true (b) Only 2 is true
   (c) Both 1 and 2 are true (d) Neither 1 nor 2 is true
   (e) Question not attempted

**Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024**

**Ans. (c)**

During the Moderate Phase (1885-1905 AD) of the Indian National Movement, there was support for the rich democratic and scientific culture of modern Europe. The moderate leaders advocated for constitutional reforms, political participation and the expansion of modern education. They supported English education, as they believed it would help develop a modern outlook and social progress in India. However, the growing masses viewed British colonial policies with increasing resentment. Notably, Dadabhai Naoroji strongly criticized the economic aspects of British colonialism. His book, "Poverty and Un-British Rule in India," highlighted issues related to the economic drain, heavy taxation, and the decline of Indian industries. The moderates attempted to address such concerns through constitutional means rather than direct confrontation.

3. **The protest method of moderate leaders of the Congress was ?**
   (a) Non-Co-operation
   (b) Constitutional agitation
   (c) Passive resistance
   (d) Civil disobedience

**48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (b)**

The methods employed by the two groups (Moderates and Extremists) of Congress were different in their tempo and approach. Congress split into two different groups at Surat Session of Congress in 1907 A.D. While the moderates had infinite faith in the efficacy of constitutional agitation and in appealing to the British sense of justice and fair play, in holding an annual conference, making speeches, passing elaborate resolutions and sending deputations to England. The extremists had no faith in the benevolence of British public or Parliament, nor were they convinced of the efficacy of merely holding conferences. Extremists had faith in the concept of passive resistance.

4. **Which one of the following movements has contributed to a split in the Indian National Congress resulting in the emergence of 'moderates' and 'extremists'?**
   (a) Swadeshi Movement
   (b) Quit India Movement
   (c) Non-cooperation Movement
   (d) Civil Disobedience Movement

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2015**

**Ans. (a)**

Surat split (1907 A.D.), refers to the split in the Congress party into two groups : 'Moderates' and 'Extremists.' Moderates believed in the policy of settlement of minor issues with Government by deliberation, strikes, and boycotts to force their demands. The moderates opposed the resolutions on Swaraj (self-governance), Swadeshi National Education and boycott of foreign goods but extremists were not in favour of these. Hence, the difference of opinion between moderates and extremists finally reached to split in the Congress at the Surat Session (1907).

5. **Most of the moderate leaders hailed from :**
   (a) Rural areas
   (b) Urban areas
   (c) Both rural and urban areas
   (d) Punjab

**43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999**

**Ans. (b)**

During the era of liberal politics Dadabhai Naoroji, Pherozeshah Mehta, Dinshaw Wacha, Womesh Chandra Banerjee and Surendranath Banerjee were the moderate leaders who hailed from urban areas. The domination of prosperous and middle-class scholars like barristers, doctors, engineers, journalists and literary people was found during this period. The title and high designation charmed them. These representatives of Congress hailed from metropolitan cities and had no connection with common people.

**6. Who of the following continuously from 1904 onwards emphasized on the grant of 'self-rule' to India?**

(a) S. N. Banerjee (b) Aurobindo Ghosh
(c) Firoz Shah Mehta (d) Dadabhai Naoroji

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016**

**Ans. (d)**

In 1904 A.D., first time Dadabhai Naoroji demanded 'Swaraj,' (Self Rule) or Self-Government in International Socialist Congress. for India and continuously emphasized the grant of Self Rule in India. In his presidential address in 1906 he demanded 'Swaraj' (Self Rule) at INC session.

**7. Which one of the following was not an extremist ?**

(a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Madan Lal
(c) Udham Singh (d) G.K. Gokhale

**44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000**

**Ans. (d)**

Gopal Krishna Gokhale was a prominent social reformer of India who founded an organization to work for the relief of underprivileged. He led the moderate nationalists in the early years of the Indian Independence Movement. As an influential and respected member of the Indian National Congress, the leading Nationalist organization in the pre-independent India, Gokhale advocated moderate and Constitutional methods of agitation and gradual reform.

**8. Who among the following was not an outstanding leader of extreme Nationalism?**

(a) Gopal Krishna Gokhale (b) Bipin Chandra Pal
(c) Lokmanya Tilak (d) Lala Lajpat Rai

**U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014**

**Ans. (a)**

Gopal Krishna Gokhale was one of the social and political leaders during the Indian Independence Movement against the British rule in India. He was a senior leader of INC, founder of the Servants of India Society. He was not a leader of extreme nationalism.

**9. Who among the following was not an extremist nationalist leader ?**

(a) Bipin Chandra Pal (b) B.G. Tilak
(c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) G.K. Gokhale

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question.

**10. Who accused Indian National Congress of practising 'politics of prayer, petition and protest'?**

(a) Lala Hardayal
(b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Subhash Chandra Bose
(d) Sardar Bhagat Singh

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002**
**U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002**

**Ans. (b)**

The first two decades are INC are described in history as a moderate era. Among some of the prominent moderate leaders were Dadabhai Naoroji, Surendra Nath Banerjee, Mahadev Govind Ranade, Pherozeshah Mehta, Gopal Krishna Gokhale and Anand Mohan Bose. They had a sense of confidence in British justice and their generosity. Their aim was not aggressive nationalism for attaining independence. Leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Lala Lajpat Rai, Bipin Chandra Pal, raised extremist ideology. B.G. Tilak accused moderates of believing in constitutional method and favouring the policy of protest, prayer, and petition.

**11. Who accused Indian National Congress of practising politics of, pray and petition and protest?**

(a) B.G. Tilak (b) M.A. Jinnah
(c) S.C. Bose (d) Annie Besant

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005**
**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002**

**Ans. (a)**

See the explanation of above question.

**12. The Congress policy of prayer and petition ultimately came to an end under the guidance of:**

(a) Aurobindo Ghosh
(b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Lala Lajpat Rai
(d) Mahatma Gandhi

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1999**

**Ans. (b)**

Congress policy of prayer and petition ultimately came to an end under the leadership of Bal Gangadhar Tilak. He was the strongest opponent of the British Empire. He strongly recommended a method of agitation. Many intellectual Congressmen became his followers. Leaders like Lala Lajpat Rai of Punjab and Bipin Chandra Pal of Calcutta turned into staunch followers of him. They strongly opposed the moderate policies of Congress.

**13. Who called the Indian National Congress as a "Begging Institute" ?**

(a) B.C. Pal (b) Tilak
(c) Aurobindo Ghosh (d) None of them

**U.P. Lower (Spl) (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (a)**

First session of Indian National Congress was held at Bombay-based Gokul Das Tezpal Sanskrit College on 28-30 December, 1885 A.D. Extremists commented negatively about Congress. B.C. Pal called the Indian National Congress as a "Begging Institute."

**14. Which statement is true regarding Bipin Chandra Pal?**

**1. He was a Brahmo Samaj Leader and Social Reformer.**
**2. A weekly magazine named New India was published.**

**Select the correct answer using the code given below: Code -**

(a) Both 1 and 2 (b) Only 1
(c) Neither 1 nor 2 (d) Only 2

**U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2023**

**Ans. (a)**

Bipin Chandra Pal was associated with Brahmo Samaj and was a social reformer. In 1901, he published a weekly magazine 'New India'.

**15. Indian National Movement came to be dominated by the extremists after –**

(a) 1906 (b) 1909
(c) 1914 (d) 1919

**43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999**

**Ans. (a)**

After the year 1906 A.D., the effect of extremism had increased on the Indian National Movement. The Congress split at Surat came in December 1907 A.D., around the time when revolutionary terrorism had gained momentum. The extremists were aggressive nationalist members of Indian National Congress. The important extremist leaders were Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal and Aurobindo Ghosh. Tilak announced that '' Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it''.

**16. Which one of the following leaders belonged to the Extremist wing of the Congress?**

(a) Aurobindo Ghosh (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) G.K. Gokhale (d) S.N. Bannerjee

**45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (a)**

Aurobindo Ghosh was an extremist of Congress. He was one of the four pillars (Lal, Bal, Pal, Ghosh) of extremists. He was arrested in 1908 A.D. by British Police in Maniktalla garden raid. He got the punishment of one-year imprisonment, but he was released due to the lack of evidence. Finally, he became sage, secluded himself from revolutionary activities and moved to Pondicherry.

**17. Who among the following was an extremist?**

(a) Firozshah Mehta (b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(c) Bipin Chandra Pal (d) None of the above

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013**

**Ans. (c)**

After the year 1906 A.D., the effect of extremism had increased on the Indian National Movement. The Congress split at Surat came in December 1907 A.D., around the time when revolutionary terrorism had gained momentum. The extremists were aggressive nationalist members of Indian National Congress. The important extremist leaders were Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal and Aurobindo Ghosh. Tilak announced that '' Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it''.

**18. Who among the following was not known as a moderate in the National Movement?**

(a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) M.G. Ranade (d) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

**Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010**
**45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (a)**

See the explanation of above question.

**19. Who is popularly known as 'Sher-e-Punjab'?**

(a) Rajguru (b) Bhagat Singh
(c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) Udham Singh

**53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011**

**Ans. (c)**

Lala Lajpat Rai was known as Sher-e-Punjab. He was extremist representative of Punjab in Congress. He is known as 'Punjab Kesari. Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal named as "Lal-Bal-Pal."

**20. Who among the following was not associated with the Moderates in Indian National Congress?**

(a) Ferozshah Mehta (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) Gopal Krishna Gokhale (d) Lala Lajpat Rai

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question.

**21. Who among of the following was considered by Lala Lajpat Rai as his political guru?**

(a) Garibaldi (b) Vivekanand
(c) Dadabhai Naoroji (d) Mazzini

**U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013**

**Ans. (d)**

Lala Lajpat Rai accepted Italian revolutionary Mazzini as his political guru after reading his biography, and later he translated splendid creation of Mazzini "The Duty of Man" in Urdu also.

**22. He wrote biographies of Mazzini, Garibaldi, Shivaji and Shrikrishna; stayed in America for some time; and was also elected to the Central Assembly. He was :**

(a) Aurobindo Ghosh (b) Bipin Chandra Pal
(c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) Motilal Nehru

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2018**

**Ans. (c)**

Indian freedom fighter Lala Lajpat Rai, popularly known as 'Punjab Kesari', lived in America for some time during his exile in the year 1907 A.D. and returned during the First World War. Along with being a politician, he was also a prolific writer. He also wrote brief biographies of Lord Krishna, Shivaji, Swami Dayanand Saraswati, Mazzini and Garibaldi. 'Unhappy India' and 'The Story of My Deportation' are his other important works.

**23. Who called the Congress Conference as the "Annual National Festival of Educated Indians"?**

(a) Lala Lajpat Rai
(b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(d) Vipin Chandra Pal

**M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021**

**Ans. (a)**

Lala Lajpat Rai has called Congress Conferences as the "Annual National Festival of Educated Indians".

**24. Who of the following was not a moderate:**

(a) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) A.O.Hume
(d) Madan Mohan Malviya

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995**

**Ans. (b)**

Neo-Nationalist group of Lal, Bal, Pal was disillusioned by initial moderate policies of Congress. Bal Gangadhar Tilak was a pioneer of this neo ideology. He was an extremist, not a moderate.

**25. Who among the following leaders was a supporter of 'Swadeshi'?**

(a) Aurobindo Ghosh
(b) Feroz Shah Mehta
(c) Dadabhai Naoroji
(d) Subhash Chandra Bose

**U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2009**

**Ans. (a)**

Aurobindo Ghosh was the main leader of Swadeshi Movement (started in 1905 A.D.) which began against the Bengal partition. Other main leaders of this movement were Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab), Bal Gangadhar Tilak (Maharashtra) and Bipin Chandra Pal (Bengal).

**26. Who among the following is known as the father of 'Indian Unrest'–**

(a) A. O. Hume (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) Lokmanya Tilak (d) Mahatma Gandhi

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (c)**

Bal Gangadhar Tilak believed in service and sacrifice. He dared to challenge the British Empire. It was the results of his efforts that the Indian National Congress became the party to criticize the British policies instead of praising British rule. Valentine Chirol termed B.G. Tilak as the father of Indian unrest. Tilak went to England to file a defamation suit against Chirol but was defeated.

**27. Who called Bal Gangadhar Tilak the 'Father of Indian Unrest'?**

(a) Lord Curzon (b) Vincent Smith
(c) Valentine Chirol (d) Henry Cotton

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**28. Who said, "Tilak is the Father of Indian Unrest"?**

(a) V. Chirol (b) Louis Fischer
(c) Web Miller (d) Lord Reading

**U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013**

**Ans. (a)**

See the explanation of above question.

**29. Who among the following has been called the 'Father of Indian Unrest'?**

(a) B.G. Tilak (b) G.K. Gokhale
(c) Subhash Chandra Bose (d) Mahatma Gandhi

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004**

**Ans. (a)**

See the explanation of above question.

**30. After the sentence of B.G. Tilak, who among the following had pleaded for mercy and said: "My interest in Tilak is that of a Sanskrit scholar"?**

(a) Rabindranath Tagore (b) Max Muller
(c) Bipin Chandra Pal (d) William Jones

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014**

**Ans. (b)**

Bal Gangadhar Tilak who was a staunch supporter of Swadeshi and belonged to an extremist camp to opposing British rule. He founded the English weekly 'The Mahratta' and the Marathi weekly the 'Kesari. Both the papers were extreme nationalists which brought Tilak within reach of criminal law. Tilak's utterances and writings were regarded as radical content and so he was sentenced. Max Muller pleaded for Government mercy for Tilak saying 'As a great scholar of Sanskrit, I am interested in Tilak.'

**31. Bal Gangadhar Tilak came to be known as 'Lokmanya Tilak' when –**

(a) he became a popular teacher
(b) he started a popular newspaper
(c) the government accused him in the Rand Murder Case
(d) he started the Shivaji and Ganpati festivals
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018**

**Ans. (e)**

British government made Bal Gangadhar Tilak accused in the Rand (Plague Commissioner of Pune) and Ayerst murder case. Tilak was convicted and sentenced to 18 months of rigorous imprisonment. He already became a national hero when he came out of jail. Hence many incidents were responsible for Tilak becoming 'Lokmanya' Tilak.

**32. Which extremist leader of the freedom movement was given 6 years jail punishment in 1908?**

(a) Bipin Chandra Pal (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) Arvind Ghosh

**Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010**

**Ans. (b)**

In 1908 Tilak was sentenced to 6 years imprisonment. He was deported to Burma and kept in Mandalay Jail.

**33. In 1908, Bal Gangadhar Tilak was imprisoned for –**

(a) 5 years (b) 6 years
(c) 7 years (d) 8 years

**43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**34. Which one of the following defines extremist ideology during the early phase of Indian freedom movement?**

(a) Stimulating the production of indigenous articles by giving them preference over imported commodities.
(b) Obtaining self-government by aggressive means in place of petitions and constitutional ways.
(c) Providing national educational according to the requirements of the country.
(d) Organizing coups against the British empire through military revolt.

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1998**

**Ans. (b)**

Moderates believed in constitutional methods of British Laws, adopting proposals and delegations to London for negotiation and discussion. On the other hand, extremists believed in aggressive protests, self-sacrifices and determination at the beginning of the Indian Independence Movement. Independence meant for extremists as Complete Independence from foreign control, while moderates meant Independence as self-governance under colonial rule.

**35. The Indian Muslims, in general, were not attracted to the extremist movement because of the:**

(a) influence of Sir Sayyid Ahmed Khan
(b) anti-Muslim attitude of extremist leaders
(c) the indifference is shown to Muslim aspirations
(d) extremists, policy of harping on Hindu part

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1998**

**Ans. (d)**

Indian Muslims, in general, were not attracted to the extremist movement because of the extremist policy of harping on Hindu part. Aurobindo Ghosh proclaimed that "Independence is the purpose of our lives and only Hindu religion will fulfill this objective. Nationality is a religion, and it is a gift of God.

**36. Assertion (A) : Bal Gangadhar Tilak was a communalist.**
**Reason (R) : He used the religion as a political weapon.**
**Select your answer by using the codes given below :**

(a) A and R both are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) A and R both are correct, but the R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is correct, but R is wrong.
(d) A is wrong, but R is correct.

**U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (d)**

The Assertion (A) in the question is not correct because Bal Gangadhar Tilak was actually a staunch nationalist who supported for 'Swaraj' as the birthright of every Indian and in this way he tried to make close contact with the people of India and his view was considered as a pioneer of M. K. Gandhi. He started 'Ganapati Parva' and 'Shivaji Mahotsava' in Maharashtra to enthuse Nationalist feelings among masses. On the other hand, he used religion as a political weapon but not for communal purposes.

**37. Ganpati festival in Maharashtra was started by :**

(a) B.G.Tilak (b) M.G. Ranade
(c) Bipin Chandra Pal (d) Aurobindo Ghosh

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005**